# YEAR END NEWSLETTER

2024-2025 has seen Act for Goa restructure to meet Goa's changing needs and to better deliver on our MoU with the Goa State Biodiversity Board (GSBB) for communication and implementation of the Goa State Climate action plan (SAPCC).

ActforGoa has orientated all activities around

- 3 key thematic focus areas and
- 4 crosscutting workstreams

We are now better poised to support stakehodlers from across society to contribute to the interconnected goals of climate resilience, inclusive green progress and cultural and natural heritage protection.

## 1. CONSCIOUS PLANNING

A cross-sector initiative bringing together planners, architects, lawyers, community members, community organizers, government bodies, and businesses to explore how Goas town and country planning can integrate climate resilience and inclusive green prosperity - both at state and village levels. This initiative kicked off on November 24 with a Circlewallas hosted participatory circle, with sponsorship for venue and food costs provided.



See the workshop report and 2-month update report here




This initiative has kickstarted

- **Legal Working Group**: looking at dymystifying planning processes and legal compliance
- **Data working group**: looking at how cutting-edge tech and data can inform and support panchayat and state-level planning
- **Village action**: pilot project in Siolim looking first at water mapping to tackle water shortages and plan for better integration of watershed management into the current planning process.
- A team working on a project proposal to prototype data-driven climate resilience planning into the Gram Panchayat Development Planning process.
- **Conscious planning framework development group:** looking at formulating a propositional Goa-specific planning process that honours the unique social and ecological context of Goa
- **Communications working group:** working on a conscious planning awareness campaign and narrative shaping.
- We are excited about this initiative and its potential to offer a different model of progress for Goa that is not about concrete urbanization. This is timely as spatial planning has just been reconfirmed as being a Panchayat responsibility.
- We will be raising funds for this important work.

# 2. NATURE CONSERVATION

In July 2024, we convened a group of nature specialists to look at how we could catalyze viable nature conservation models in the context of rising real estate prices. This group recommended :

- Working on the ground in a few villages to create model villages that can test ideas out
- Scoping social enterprise business models for land use, specifically exploring the potential of a land trust
- Creating a structure to enable co-working for the long term rather than getting stuck in short term project stop/start patterns (This informed the new AfG strategy)
- Separately through our collaboration with Goa Institute of Management we also facilitated a dashboard of traditional healers for GSBB



# 3. REGENERATIVE TOURISM

Responding to the Government's promotion of Regenerative Tourism, we also engaged different stakeholders

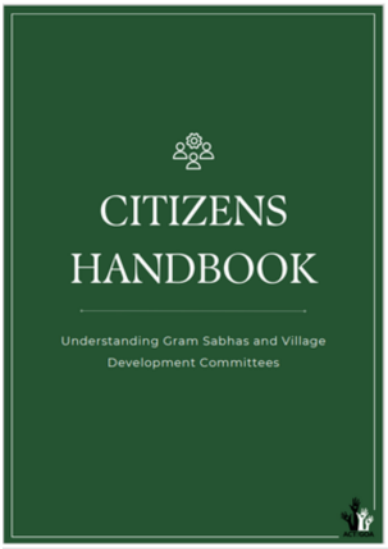
- We convened international and Goa-based stakeholders to explore what was needed to scale regenerative tourism beyond niche. Participants included the Global Ecovillage Network, the Travel and Tourism Association of Goa (TTAG), and the global Sustainable Hospitality Alliance, as well as regenerative tourism stakeholders from Goa such as Make It Happen, Natures Nest, center for Responsible Tourism. The key next steps are
  - a regenerative tourism club enabling a financial model around more conscious tourism operators
  - a Spirit of Goa campaign to help tell the stories of the real Goa we know and love.
- We designed a project along with government and industry bodies to develop a shared vision of excellence in Goa and means of activating this including through standards and a group of front-runners as well as collaboration. Shortly to seek funding for this.




GLOBAL ECOVILLAGE NETWORK
MAP OF REGENERATION

# 4. CROSS CUTTING WORKSTREAMS :

**Comms for behavior change:**
Continuing the need for simple civic information messaging and amplification of simple ways to make a difference we:




- Worked with Aware citizens of Assagao to create a citizens handbook on panchayat workings in English and Konkani.
- Translated the ActforGoa principles into Konkani




- Built a team to develop the Spirit of Goa and Give Back to Goa campaigns.
- Continued social media and WhatsApp amplifying of green activities in Goa.
- Social media this year has been less due to having no coordinator for 7 months.

**MOG xAct for Goa Series**
We also hosted 6 events in partnership with MoG Sundays on 1) waste management 2) responsible tourism, 3) spirituality and ecology, 4) conscious planning 5) Marine Ecology and 6) responsible citizenship - the role of citizens in legal compliance.

MUSEUM OF GOA

Each of these events resulted in a poster of different ways that diverse stakeholders can conribute

**Network building and collaboration:**
Continuing our vision of a connected network of organisations collaborating for a green climate resilient Goa, we did outreach and collaborations with a variety of stakeholders including:

- Goa Institute of Management, Goa College of Archictecture
- Radio Indigo, Herald
- Goa Pollution Control board, Goa Institute of Public Administration and Rural Development.
- Civic groups in a number of villages including Arpora, Siolim and Assagao.

**Village/place-based on ground prototypes:**
Ensuring our systemic State level work is grounded in ground realities, we are working on village prototypes in Siolim and Verna, with new villages to come online in 2025 once the conscious planning/date-driven village planning project is underway.

**Data and Tech:**
Building on the websitee that contains a green directory and resource bank of green resources, we are now building out tech and data tools to support wider participation in sustianble development.

- Working with AnAngel.earth to develop the Indian AnAngel interface - a platform enabling mobilization of resources (volunteers, funding, etc) for doing good, gamified (Karmapoints redeemable at businesses), and verified monitoring with Blockchain.
- Also exploring working with the Goa remote sensing center to explore how data can support climate-resilient development.
- We are testing a mapping approach to enable mass volunteer mapping of assets and issues to support participatory sustainable development

ACT FOR GOA

# ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

ActforGoa is a collaborative platform enabling stakeholders from across society to contribute to a clean, green, resilient, inclusive, and prosperous Goa, ensuring the protection of natural and cultural heritage.
Actforgoa celebrates responsible citizenship and enables collaboration across societal divides to meet the needs of our times.

ActforGoa runs on the goodwill of volunteers and has plans to further support volunteerism at scale in Goa, as well as enable the mobilisation of all kinds of other resources towards a green future for Goa.

We celebrate and remain enormously grateful to

The cofounders of ActforGoa, Dean D Cruz, Reboni Saha, Stalin K, Jessica Mayberry, Jill Ferguson, Tamer Salameh and Joanna Pyres who have supported the idea of a Goa platfrom since its inception and continue to act as Stewards of the platform in a board capacity.

Those who have stepped forward to lead ActforGoa's next chapter of impact – Maya D Souza, Joanna Pyres, Neha Bhattia, Trella Rodrigues, and Tamer Salameh.

Those whohave/are providing advice such as Sachin Tendulkar (Mineral Foundation of Goa) Jack Sukhija (Panjim Inn & TTAG), Puja Mitra (Terra Conscious) Johann Fernandes (Climatexcapital) , Nirmal Kulkarni (Madhei Research Centre), Arvind Nair (Hooop marketing) and many others.

The numerous volunteers who give their time to support positive collective action such as Abha Mehendiratta (cultural heritage) Marilyn Fernandes, (Comms) Meena Pillai (Comms) Malcolm Afonso (Data) Marlon Rodrigues (Data) Paromita (Legal) Aurobindo Gomes Perreira (Legal) Shreya Basu (events)

Those who provide financial support such as Gokhul Charity who offered a h 1L donation. Anil Rao who suponsoerd the Conscious Planning event costs. Maya D Souza who provided a 50L donation.

The 2024-2025 operating budget of ActforGoa was 3L, of which 2L was spent on coordintor salary and 1L on tech hosting and accountancy costs.

.